

Cover to Cover
Through The Bible In A Year
Genesis 18

Reminder: we mentioned last week that 17:21 God promises again that AT THIS TIME NEXT YEAR" Sarah will have a son and he will be called Issac.

Remember....The LORD says ONE YEAR...and you carry a child for 9 months...so Sarah will become pregnant very soon...within the next three months.

Sarah got anxious and tried to produce her promise through a surrogate. Pay attention to this... can't nobody do what God ordained you to do. What God has for you can't come through anybody but you.

Your blessing has your name on it, and no matter what it looks like right now no matter how long you've been waiting, you will deliver what God has promised. Understand this... Sarah was barren in the flesh and divinely fertile at the same time! Don't give up or settle, or try to take a short cut because your promise hasn't shown up yet... wait on the Lord! **God did for Sarah in one year what Sarah couldn't do on her own in 90 years**stay in faith... this is your season of acceleration. God is going to do for you in the next 12 months what you haven't been able to do in the last ? (you put how many years you've been waiting for the miracle) many years... declare it my latter will be greater than my former.

NOW Chapter 18...

In the last chapter, it mentions that Abram is 99 years old...What happens in Gen 18 is just a short time after that encounter in chapter 17 where Abram is told about the mark of circumcision as a sign of the covenant.

Let me show you something about the number 99.

Counting to 100 for the ancient semitic people was about as far as the average person could go.

there was something psychological about the number 100 to their minds.

Remember the parable of the 99 sheep in Luke 15: 3-7?

100 sheep was the threshold to being rich.

With 99 sheep, you were not yet rich... but 100 put you in the next tax bracket.

Thus, it was a psychological blow to a shepherd who lost one sheep from his 100 fold. If his number dropped below 100 to 99, the shepherd would feel incomplete.

99 left a person wanting, feeling unfulfilled and desiring more.

In ancient gematria, 90 is the number of humility and 9:00 represents divine completeness. Thus, we are to be divinely completed before we are physically completed.

Maybe God's delay in giving Abraham the promised child wasn't so much to test his faith as it certainly did but to wait for Abraham to reach a state of divine completeness in humility before bringing that special child into his life!

The Hebrew words for 99 come from a Hebrew root word meaning "a moment in time" or "a pause before the next event!"

Abraham was in the age of life where you would settle back and look forward to retirement. And God shows up and says hey Abraham... this is just a moment in time... Get ready for the next event in your life! It's going to blow your mind!

Notice that by chapter 17: 17 Abraham is 100 years old... did it take a full year to have this conversation that guard started in 17: one with him being 99? Next paragraph 100 is considered the number of completion. In 17: 1 Abraham is telling God hey I am all done... I'm finished and ready to join you in that bosom that everyone is talking about and God goes... no, you are not finished you are only 99 and I say you will be 100 and reach completion. I am expecting good things from you. There is something else I need you to complete.

The LORD appears to Abraham by the terebinth trees of Mamre in Hebron.

"Oaks of Mamre", refers to an ancient religious site originally focused on a single holy tree growing "since time immemorial" at Hebron in Caanan.

The first mention of this tree is in Genesis 13:18: Abraham moved to **Mamre** when he came back into the promised land from Egypt and built an altar there ([Genesis 13:18](#)) The construction of an altar signifies Abram's

devotion and commitment to God, establishing the site as a place of divine encounter.

Genesis 14:13 : It's mentioned again when a fugitive of the war of the 4 kings fighting against 5 other kings and the news that LOT has been captured....so apparently Abram stayed there some time ([Genesis 14:13](#)).

And now its mentioned a third time here in 18:1

The terebinth trees of Mamre: Abraham purchased a field and cave at **Mamre**, using it for Sarah's burial ([Genesis 23:17-19](#)).

Abraham himself was buried there ([Genesis 25:9](#)), and his son Isaac was also buried there ([Genesis 49:30](#), [50:13](#)).

VS 2: SAYS THERE are 3 men standing there.

Some say this is the Trinity...but the scripture states that no man has seen the Father...John 6:46

the Lord (in the Person of Jesus Christ) has appeared to Abraham twice before ([Genesis 12:7](#), [17:1](#)),

This is a Christophany.

Christophany – A Pre-Incarnate Appearance of Christ

- Many Christian scholars believe that this is a pre-incarnate appearance of Jesus Christ (called a Christophany).
- Why? Because Jesus is the visible image of the invisible God (Colossians 1:15), and no one has seen the Father(John 1:18), yet Abraham saw the LORD.

vs 2: He bowed down to the ground shows that Abram recognized these men as superiors to him.

And the fact that HE RAN....is a big deal.. men were not allowed to do this. You had to pick up your garments and reveal your legs and that was a no no in those days.

In vs 3 Abram is basically begging them to not leave...to stay awhile. God has shown up right outside your tent...He is been waiting 24 years for this promise to come to pass...and Abraham is like, "Ill do whatever it takes, just please don't pass by and stay here until your promise is fulfilled.

He's tired of the long periods of silence and he's like just stop and be with us.

So he brings water to wash their feet...and says I'll bring you a morsel of bread that you may refresh yourselves.

Abraham knows they've arrived ON PURPOSE. His tent is their destination!

MEAL:

There is something special about these 3 visitors and so there is an urgency to prepare a meal.

HOSPITALITY Was a big deal in that day. If travelers were passing through, you offering them lodging, food and water, even cared for their animals. You did this because it might be you one day that is traveling and needing lodging and food. It was like an ancient law that you have to show hospitality in that day because if you ever find yourself in that situation you would need someone to do the same for you. Survival was very hard in the ancient world. So hospitality was essential.

Verse 6 Abraham tells Sarah quickly get ready 3 measures of fine meal, knead it and bake cakes.

That's not a little morsel. It's about 21 quarts. So basically 50 lbs of fine flour so there's 4 quarts in a gallon so we're talking 5 and 1/4 gallon jugs of flour. That's a lot of flour. To feed three people and you know when you use flour to make bread it becomes more bread. So that's 50 lbs of flour that's enough to feed 100 people and that's what Abraham wants to prepare for these three men.

Verse 7 Abraham goes and gets a calf and has his servant butcher and prepare it

Do you know how much a calf reeds? They weigh about 400 lbs so that means about 150 to 400 lbs of meat. Think about it if you eat a 12 ounce or 16 ounce steak that's very filling and you're good. But we're talking about 150 to 400 of these so they basically have enough meat to feed 100 people.

verse 8 he took curds and milk and the calf which he had prepared and set it before the men and he stood beside them under the tree while they ate.

He took curds and milk

we're talking cards that takes a lot of time to prepare in a warm climate like that. They take 5 or 6 hours to prepare.

And then all the time it took to prepare all of this. It wasn't a real quick process it took a lot of time.

What is Abraham doing? He's saying I want you to commit to be here. Because by the time they get all this ready it's going to be nightfall and they're going to have to sleep there. That's what he's thinking. He's saying I don't want you to go anywhere. You keep making this promise and then you disappear for another decade.

And then Abraham just goes over and stands by the tree as these three men are served all this food. He sends his servants away and he becomes the waiter.

Notice he is standing by that tree and it's the very tree where God gave him the first promise. He standing there hoping that the Lord remembers that right here after Lot left you came and you said that you were going to do all these things for me and remember I built an altar over there when you gave me that promise... like it's right over there. He's saying I'm ready. Don't leave. Give it to me. What's it going to be?

And the next words out of the Lord's mouth is after he has prepared and given this huge feast is... where is Sarah your wife.

This is Sarah's reality. She got the promise from God at 65 years old period she's endured decades of shame that she was barren. God asked them to leave everything and go to a land that he was going to show them. She grew up in polygamy where her mom was not the primary wife. Years go by and nothing is happening for her to overcome her bareness. So she thinks she's the problem and she gives Hagar to Abraham and when she does Abraham does not fight for her doesn't defend her doesn't insist on staying faithful to her he's like OK that sounds good and Hagar gets pregnant and Abraham falls in love with this boy. And when Hagar runs away because Sarah mistreated her God shows up and gives her a promise but he's never spoken anything directly to Sarah. But he shows up and tells Hagar that Ishmael's going to have a great nation and all of these great things are going to come from him and Hagar names God the God who sees me and she comes back to Sarah and Abraham and tells Abraham all these things and Sarah is taking this all in and thinking he has never appeared to me and I don't feel heard.

I don't feel seen. Maybe the promise is passing me by. She's increasingly isolated and she's in this tent listening through the tent door and she hears God ask for her.

Sarah probably with all the shame in all the decisions that she's made that have caused chaos and a big mess she probably feels disqualified and feels

like she is outside of the love of God. She probably feels like she's outside of the covenant. That she has no right to claim anything and here is God showing up to Abraham and saying thank you for the meal but where's your wife... She's the one we're looking for.

Remember she's the fourth woman mentioned in the Bible and she's the first woman in the line of Seth.

Someone once said that the most trustworthy thing that someone says about you is what you overhear them say when they don't know you are listening.

If they tell it to you to your face then that might be flattery but if they tell it to someone else then you're not there then it is a trustworthy thing.

Verse 10 notice what God says to Abraham and to Sarah. She's in the tent but he's talking to her and to Abraham... I will surely return to you at this time next year and behold Sarah your wife will have a son. And Sarah was listening at the tent door which was behind him. Now the English does not pull out what is pretty cool about this. The word there about this time next year is actually the meaning when things come to life again. It's talking about spring. It's when the time of reviving comes. I'm coming to you this time when everything is brought back to life. Why is this significant? Because that's her womb right now. It's literally a picture of resurrection. The dead season is about to pass I will bring about a life to you when the time of reviving comes. God is all about resurrection here.

Now you would think that Sarah's heart would explode with joy. Right? And with gratitude.

Instead it says in the very next verse now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in years; She was past the age of childbearing. That's verse 11

genesis really wants you to remember that. Moses is writing this book and so it's like every chance he has he's reminding us they're really old. So the way of women has ceased to be with Sarah this means she's postmenopausal.

And in verse 12 it says Sarah laughed to herself when she heard the Lord's words saying after I had become old shall I have pleasure and delight, my lord (husband) being also old

Now in Romans 4 it talks about when Abraham brings about Isaac, that it was partly miraculous because his body was as good as dead. It's no longer just Sarah who's bearing... it's no longer just sarah's body that's no longer capable of producing children. Abraham's not able to participate anymore either.

The word shall I have pleasure... the word pleasure is the Hebrew word DNA and it comes from the root word Eden. And it's literally means can you restore everything that was beautiful and wonderful?

Then verse 13 says... and the Lord asked Abraham why did Sarah laugh to herself saying shall I really give birth to a child when I am so old?

And the word there for laughter is like mocking. She's basically saying this is ridiculous. And hang on to that word because in a couple of chapters when Ishmael's going to be sent away, the word is going to be mocking... and it's the same word as laughter. That word has a big deal to play in the story. So she laughs at God and the Lord said to Abraham why did Sarah laugh?

Notice he asked Abraham that. He's asking how is it that your wife feels so forsaken and so cut out of the promises that I've given you? Haven't you assured her? Haven't you shared the promises with her? Have you not comforted her?

And then all of a sudden Sarah speaks up and says I didn't laugh for she was afraid. In verse 15. And God says no, you did laugh.

But the verse says she laughed to herself... So what does that tell us? All of a sudden Sarah knows that she can't have a private thought from God. He knows where her heart is. She's probably thinking what else has he heard over the last 24 years of bitterness and grumbling and anger at God and feeling betrayed? And here he is still chasing me. This shows the relentless and Amazing Grace of God.

She is mocking in her heart at him he is like I want to know her period why is she doing this Abraham? Like, why does she not feel precious? Why have you failed in this? God is showing he's concerned about her heart even as internally she's mocking him or at least laughing at the promise. It's pretty amazing. God is protecting her in this. God is showing up on her side and asking Abraham to bring her along.

He has failed miserably at this because back in Genesis 12 when he lied to Pharaoh about her God had to show up to rescue for the end. But because God doesn't move on her timetable she feels forsaken.

But yet God is relentless. He does not give up on her.

And he is showing her that he knows what's going on inside of her she's behind the tent door. She didn't laugh out loud. She laughed on the inside so that means that God knows what's going on inside of me. This means he knows all the parts that are broken or barren or whatever. He's sovereign. He can see far more than I want to give him credit for.

God loves Sarah more than Abraham does.
He cares about Ishmael more than Abraham does.
He cares about Isaac more than Abraham does.

And he does the same for us. When we're making a mess out of our lives and out of our relationships he's patient to keep pursuing us. He just keeps chasing after his people and bringing beautiful things even out of our own stupidity. That's what you see in the story. You can look at Abraham and Sarah and Hagar and go yuck right? And yet God is in the midst of it. Faithful as can be, beautiful as can be, filling in all the gaps. And making it all beautiful.

And there's a comfort in that. God's going to fill in all the gaps and he's going to bring light out of the darkness. He's a good God! Amen?

GENESIS 19

About 3600 years ago.

This is the R OR X rated chapter of the Bible.

Sodom is the first judgement since the flood

the main characters of this story, Lot.

Abraham's nephew.

Abraham and Lot agreed that they should part ways.

when they parted ways that Lot ran away from the Promised Land and toward this land that appeared to be a land of great prosperity, a land of great paradise.

But it was also a land that was extremely wicked.

Lot made that move, because as is seen earlier in Genesis, he did not trust God to keep him safe and secure. He needed a city, a powerful and prosperous city to make him feel safe and secure.

In [Genesis 19](#) we see Lot in Sodom.

Read Genesis 19:1-3

Lot was sitting in the gate of Sodom:

There was a steady progression of compromise in Lot's life.

He went from looking toward Sodom ([Genesis 13:10](#)),

to pitching his tent toward Sodom ([Genesis 13:12](#)),

to living in Sodom and losing everything when Sodom was attacked ([Genesis 14:12](#)).

Now, back at the infamous city, Lot sat in **the gate of Sodom**, indicating he was a civic leader.

The **gate** area of an ancient city was sort of a town hall where the important men of the city judged disputes, conferred with one another, and supervised those who entered and left the city.

Lot himself was a righteous man who was grieved by the sin he saw around him ([2 Peter 2:7-8](#)).

But... he was also a man of compromise.

Tragically, because of his deep compromise, few of his family and none of his friends were spared God's judgment.

Compromise destroyed his testimony.

The story begins when two angels arrive at the city gates in Sodom, in the evening. Lot sees them because for some reason it is late at night and he hasn't gone home yet. He's still at the city gates and he is kind to them.

He bows before them, he offers them hospitality, and invites them to stay at his house.

At this point Lot doesn't know that the two angels are angels. Lot sees them as men, they have chosen to appear to him as regular men. Lot doesn't know he is offering hospitality to angels.

He sees two men in a wicked city, late at night who say they are going to sleep in the city square.

Well Lot knew how dangerous that would be. Lot knew, knowing his city, how foolish it would be for anyone to spend the night in the city square. No telling what might happen to them. So he says to them "Come with me to my house and eat a meal."

They are finishing their meal, and Suddenly "all the men from every part of the city of Sodom—both young and old—surrounded the house." Vs4 Cities at this time could be 50-150-or-so people.

Vs 5:

They called to Lot, "Where are the men who came to you tonight? Bring them out to us so that we can have sex with them."

We are already beginning to see a contrast between Lot and the rest of the city of Sodom.

When Lot saw the two visitors he went out of his way to show them hospitality, even insisting that they come to his house. When the rest of Sodom heard about the visitors they went out of their way to rape them.

he goes outside himself and shuts the door behind him, facing the mob alone...

Read Vs 6-8 look what Lot says to them ...why would he offer this?

Lot was so familiar with this city and with the men that he knew they were so perverted they would have zero interest in his daughters.

That was a foolish and huge risk...but his assumption he was certainly right, because the men of the city did reject the offer and they threaten Lot, "We'll treat you worse than them!"

They are finishing men press Lot against the DOOR. The angels reach out and grab Lot and get him in the house. And strike the men with blindness. Vs 9-11

Door

We are shown a pattern here in this story:

There's always salvation behind a door.

Then there's going to be deliverance.

There's going to be judgement.

Then after the judgement, there's going to be somebody who says, but I want to go back because I love THAT more.

In all of these stories there are 2 messengers:

Salvation behind a door

Lot family or people being delivered.

Then somebody who wants to go back to the old way...

Then God brings judgement.

We will see this in several places that we will study in coming days:

When we get to Egypt and the Exodus...

You've got Moses and Aaron pleading/praying to God for deliverance.

Then the door...where does the door come into play? Blood on the doorposts.

Everybody behind the door is marked for salvation.

Everyone without blood marked on their door is marked for judgement and loses the firstborn.

Then you get the Hebrews/God's people that he's delivered who complain and want to go back... "we had leeks and onions in Egypt"

Then God judges Egypt...all the firstborn sons die.

JOSHUA/JERICO

Then you get to Joshua sending spies into the land. 2 of them go to.

Rahab's house...and they make a promise to Rahab...everyone behind

Rahab's door where the scarlet thread is hanging out the window will live.

They all conquer Jericho...God says don't take anything from there. But there is one guy, Achan...who takes some of the treasures and hides it in his tent.

And God brings judgement on Achan and his whole family.

there's a pattern with the DOOR...

Then you get to Revelation 11:3...it's talking about the final judgement...

2 witnesses are sent to bring the warning.

And the scripture says of Jesus: Behold I stand at the door and knock... if anyone will open up and come in and dine with me...

But if you're on the other side of the door there is judgement.

But if you are IN CHRIST...inside the door...you are saved.
If you are OUTSIDE of CHRIST....there is judgement for you.

The angels explain the reason they were in Sodom: "We are going to destroy this place. The outcry to the Lord against its people is so great that he has sent us to destroy it." Vs 12-15

the angels made it clear that they were not just in Sodom to judge Sodom and its inhabitants. They were also in Sodom to rescue Lot and his family.

Lot doesn't want to go where they are telling him to go.

Lot thinks, *I am not going to be safe there*. Forgetting the fact that is where God told him to go. So Lot begs them to let him go somewhere else. Somewhere of his choosing instead of God's.

He doesn't trust God to protect him where God has called him. So he takes matters into his own hands and tells God he wants to go over there instead. Lot is saying to these angels, and to God, "Over there is going to be much better, trust me I know."

The City DESTROYED BY FIRE:

Archeologists, Steven Collin's, has discovered this place, Tell.
AHammam...that matches this place of Sodom.

It matches a city destroyed completely by fire.

The archaeologist say that it left the city uninhabited from being like the major city of the region, suddenly uninhabited and uninhabitable 700 years after the fiery destruction.

This place is five times bigger than Jericho. It has 62 acres inside 18 feet thick walls.

So this is 3700+ years ago... This is a massively fortified city. So was a very big place. So you can imagine if that's the big city and what it's exporting and what it's importing... There was big business going on there.

So one of the things they found when they were digging in all of the buildings is that there is evidence that shows that the city was hit from something up above.

And the scripture says that God rain down fire and brimstone or sulfur.

It is believed that this whole region was demolished by a meteor Exploded.

Basically the city of Sodom was blasted to smithereens by a massive asteroid explosion. There is evidence that shows that an asteroid came, exploded over the north northern side of the Dead Sea. And that is where Sodom is located just to the north of the Dead Sea.

One of the places, one of the first places that the archaeologist uncovered was called the red Palace because it was burned, and it was burned from above. They had to remove several feet of ash in this place.

The university of South Carolina archaeology and anthropology Institute states there is evidence that this place was hit by a meteor.

They stay... And unseen out of space rock was speeding toward them at about 38,000 miles an hour flashing through the atmosphere. The rock

exploded in a massive fireball about 2 1/2 miles above ground. The blast was about 1000 times more powerful than DHIROSHIM a atomic bomb that shocked city dwellers, who stared at it, and we were instantly blinded. Air temperatures rapidly rose above 3600°F. Clothing and would immediately burst into flames. Sword, spears, mud bricks, pottery began to melt. The entire city was on fire some seconds later a massive shock wave smashed into the city moving about 740 mph.

It was More powerful than the worst tornado ever recorded. Deadly winds ripped through the city demolishing every building which they've uncovered.

None of the 8000 people or any of the animals within the city survived. Their bodies were torn apart. Their bones blasted into small fragments. They found pottery shards that were blistered, but they were blistered in a way to where they were called trinitite rocks.

In 1945 when they were doing the atomic blast testing, the explosion and the heat and the pressure generated from the atomic bomb testing left TRINITITE rocks blistered. And that is what you find in the ruins of this ancient mound of Sodom.

So it requires 2500°, which is hotter than magma. It's hotter than the average house fire, so it's not like some invaders. Just set the place on fire. Meteoric stones peppered the ground, creating dimenoids. The sand is crushed into shocked, quartz and cracked and scientist that are looking at this state that requires 725,000 pounds per square inch to create shocked quartz like that. That kind of pressure would be similar to stacking 100 pick up trucks on your thumb. That's the kind of pressure it's referring to.

One of the things that they found in their report is that when this meteor comes and explodes over the dead Sea, it then pushed shockwave down into the dead Sea and shoves that seawater all over the land. What's unique about the dead sea? It's salty. It's 10 times more salty than the

oceans. You will float in the dead seawater. So now imagine, a meteor, exploding, hitting that massively, salty region, and then it shoves all this melted and evaporated salt all over the land. That's 740 mph.

While we know it as the "Dead Sea," the Bible name is "*the salt sea*" (Genesis 14:3; Numbers 34:3,12; Deuteronomy 3:17; Joshua 3:16; Joshua 12:3; Joshua 15:2,5; Joshua 18:19).

Did you know that in the ancient world What they would do to enemies territories after they conquer them? They would salt it. They would take salt and scatter it all over the farm lands because if you salt someone else's fields, nothing ever grows there again.

When Lot picked this Land, if you remember... He said he looked out over the land and he saw this lush land that was like Eden... Like a garden... It's a well watered land like the garden of the Lord... And he picks that direction to go when he and Abraham split up.

And then now this massive shock wave of salt is shoved all over that lush land, and now nothing grows there and in the scientist report it states it is a devastated land of approximately 500 km² immediately north of the Dead Sea, including Tel al-hamam which is the location of Sodom. With a superheated brine of Dead Sea salt, pushed over the landscape by the frontal shockwave. So just imagine that salt covering everything.

AGO chemical analysis of six soil and ash samples revealed that salt and sulfate levels were greater than 6% in the ash layer, more than 5% in the soil layers immediately above and below the ash layer.

So when it comes to salt content on soil that causes crops to not grow on it ever again is represent it when you have 12,800 ppm you cannot get seeds to germinate and in this situation it is saying between 50,000 and 60,000 ppm is what the salt content is in the soil.

Well, how did it get there? From the explosion that then covered everything with this melted dehydrated salt that covered everything and stepped to all the plants and killed it all.

Lots wife. Pillar of salt.

Vs26... but lots wife look back longingly and was turned into a pillar of salt.

She loved Sodom. She wanted to go back. Her heart was there. She was not wanting to follow God. She stopped. She didn't want the salvation. And she literally turned back because her heart was set on Sodom, not on the Lord.

Lot Wife wanted to keep her old life. She ran back to it. She lost everything. Her affections were back there.

On the southwestern shore of the Dead Sea is Mount Sodom, a 700-foot- (213-meter-) tall hill made primarily of salt. A section of it is a formation resembling a pillar, aptly named "Lot's Wife." While this landform is probably not actually her, we can appreciate the scientific plausibility of her turning into salt in this very area. She became physically incorporated into the same land she so desired to continue "occupying!"

Col 3:2. Set your affections on things above, not on the things of earth. Keep your eyes fixed on Jesus.

LAST OF CHAPTER 19

Lot after being freed from judgement does not respond as we hope he would respond—filled with honor and gratitude to God.

No instead, Lot sins by becoming so drunk that he does not even know what is going on with his body.

His daughters, who are equally wicked, then sin by taking advantage of his drunkenness and committing incest as a means to perpetuate the family line.

This doesn't sound like the biography of a family who is worthy of being rescued from judgment.

This doesn't read like the biography of the super righteous people who were so righteous that God rescued them Sodom and Gomorrah.

It sounds like even though they didn't live in Sodom anymore Sodom still lived in them. There was wickedness in their hearts and no matter how many times you change where a person lives you cannot change what lives in them.

Sodom was in the hearts of Lot and his daughters. Wickedness, unrighteousness, and evil lived inside this man and his daughters and obviously his wife.

This is the origin of The moabites and Ammonites ...who will be 2 of Israel's neighbors and enemies.

They deserved to be swallowed up in judgment just as the city of Sodom was. But they weren't. Again, the question is why? Why in the world did God save them? It's clearly not because they were righteous people. If Lot and his daughters were not saved because of their own righteousness why were they saved at all?

To answer that question we need to go backwards. We need to rewind the story to 24 hours before Sodom and Gomorrah was erased by God's hand.

Chapt 18...16-33

The outcry of the people of Canaan was so great against Sodom.

And God tells Abraham What he's gonna do, because he wants Abraham to do something. God wants Abraham to respond to what he's just revealed to Abraham. God reveals things because he wants people to respond to his revelation.

Abraham does precisely what God wants him to do—Abraham prays.

This is a picture of intercession for us. And shows us that we can change Gods mind through our prayers.

He requested that god spare the city for

50

40

30

20

10 righteous people.

And each time the lord said I won't destroy it if there are that many righteous in the city.

e Abraham prayed on their behalf. Look at [Genesis 19:29](#), "So when God destroyed the cities of the plain, he remembered Abraham, and he

brought Lot out of the catastrophe that overthrew the cities where Lot had lived."

Lot was saved because Abraham prayed. When Lot didn't know how to pray for himself, Abraham knew how to pray for him.

God didn't save Lot because of Lot. He saved Lot and his family because Abraham had prayed for them. Lot didn't deserve rescue, but somewhere there was a man who loved him and prayed for him, and, for Abraham's sake, God saved Lot. He sent his angels to literally pull Lot out of Sodom to safety.

Our role is the same: to pray consistently and persistently for God to keep those we know and love not just safe but *faithful*. And, we can pray for others with even more power than Abraham did!

Biblical Sins of Sodom and Gomorrah:

1. Sexual immorality and perversion (Jude 1:7)
2. Pride and arrogance (Ezekiel 16:49)
3. Neglect of the poor and needy (Ezekiel 16:49)
4. Inhospitality and violence (Genesis 19)
5. Detestable acts (Ezekiel 16:50)

Scientific Insights:

- Tall el-Hammam may be Sodom.
- Archaeological evidence points to extreme heat and sudden destruction.
- A meteor airburst likely caused the devastation.
- Parallels the biblical account of divine fire from heaven.

